
POLLITY

Building India's Last Mile of Digital Governance

Feasibility Summary Critical Analysis

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Prepared by: Piyush Zaware, Co-Founder & CTO
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Preamble

This document is an internal, adversarial critique of Pollity’s February 2026 Feasibility Summary prepared for the UChicago Booth Social New Venture Challenge (SNVC). The purpose is not to undermine the venture but to identify every argument, assumption, and number that will be challenged by a sophisticated investor, a domain expert, or a government stakeholder—before those conversations happen.

The analysis is structured around ten critical failure points. Each section identifies the claim made in the original document, the critical problem with that claim, and a recommended fix or reframe.

Overall assessment: The core business idea is real and worth pursuing. The document as currently written will not survive a 30-minute session with a sharp investor. The gaps are fixable.

Market Sizing: The TAM Is Not a TAM

The Claim

The document states a Total Addressable Market (TAM) of **\$78.6M annually**, derived by multiplying every elected representative in India (343,000) by full pricing at each tier.

The Problem

A TAM calculation must account for willingness-to-pay, budget legality, and realistic reachability. The document does none of these.

The Panchayat Revenue Line Is Not Real

253,163 panchayat sarpanchs at \$5/month generates a \$15.18M TAM figure—but this assumes 10% freemium-to-paid conversion among representatives earning *Rs.2,000–10,000/month* in honorariums. The \$5/month (*Rs.499*) price point represents 5–25% of a sarpanch’s monthly income. This is not a viable SaaS price point for this population.

Ward Funds Cannot Pay for SaaS

The document lists “*Rs.10–50L ward funds*” as the budget source for municipal councillors. Ward development funds are government allocations earmarked for infrastructure and public works under the PFMS (Public Financial Management System). They **cannot legally be used to pay for private SaaS subscriptions**. This is a fundamental misunderstanding of municipal finance in India. There is no budget line from which a municipal councillor can pay *Rs.4,999/month* for software.

The Corrected Market Sizing

Table 1: Revised Market Sizing with Realistic Assumptions

Tier	Count	Realistic Price	Realistic TAM
MPs	788	\$249	\$2.35M
MLAs/MLCs	4,550	\$149	\$8.14M
Municipal Councillors	85,000	\$20 (halved for WTP)	\$20.4M
Panchayat (paid only, 3%)	7,595	\$5	\$0.46M
Revised TAM			\$31.3M

The \$31.3M revised figure is still a substantial market. Lead with this number; \$78.6M will be challenged immediately.

Recommendation

Remove the panchayat tier from the TAM calculation entirely or reframe it as a social impact metric, not a revenue line. Halve the councillor price assumption to reflect realistic

willingness-to-pay. Acknowledge that ward funds cannot be used for SaaS and identify the actual budget source (personal/office discretionary funds).

Unit Economics: The Lifetime Assumptions Are Unsupported

The Claim

Average customer lifetimes of 7.7–8.3 years yield LTV:CAC ratios of 23:1–24.9:1, demonstrating “strong unit economics.”

The Problem

The 7.7–8.3 year average lifetime is the most consequential unvalidated assumption in the entire document. It is buried in a table without justification.

- Indian Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha terms are **5 years**. Historical re-election rates for Indian MPs are 40–50%. This implies structural churn of 25–30% every 5 years from electoral defeat alone.
- Party defections, floor crossings, disqualifications, and by-elections create mid-cycle churn that does not appear in the model.
- Post-election churn events (a state assembly election affects 250+ MLA accounts simultaneously) are not modelled. Revenue could fall 30% in a single quarter following a state election.

Corrected Unit Economics

Table 2: LTV Sensitivity to Customer Lifetime Assumptions

Tier	Monthly Price	Doc Lifetime	Realistic Life-time	Revised LTV
MPs	\$249	8.3 yr	4 yr	\$11,952
MLAs	\$149	7.7 yr	3.5 yr	\$6,258
Councillors	\$49	6.5 yr	3 yr	\$1,764
LTV:CAC at realistic lifetimes: MPs 11.9:1 MLAs 10.4:1 Councillors 8.8:1				

These revised ratios still exceed the 3:1 benchmark—but the story changes from “exceptional” to “solid.” Investors who know Indian electoral cycles will run this calculation themselves. Do it first.

Recommendation

Ground the lifetime assumption in electoral cycle data. Model an explicit “election-year churn scenario” showing the business survives a bad election cycle. This demonstrates analytical rigor, not weakness.

Competitive Landscape: Three Omissions That Will Kill the Pitch

The Claim

“No direct competitor offers an integrated governance management platform for elected representatives.” Three adjacent categories (CPGRAMS, generic CRM, campaign tools) are dismissed in six sentences.

The Problem

I-PAC Is Not Just an Election Tool

I-PAC earned *Rs.*209 crore in FY24 serving the same customer base. The document correctly notes this validates willingness-to-pay. But it fails to note that I-PAC already runs **year-round constituency communication programs** for several state governments. They have the relationships, the political trust, 100+ employees, and the capital to build what Pollity is building in 6 months the moment they see product-market fit validated by a smaller player.

NIC + State Portals Offer the Same Thing for Free

The National Informatics Centre and state IT departments maintain constituency portals for representatives in Maharashtra, Gujarat, Telangana, and other digitally advanced states. These are free. A representative will always choose a free government tool over a *Rs.*14,999/month subscription if they perform comparably, even if slightly worse.

WhatsApp CRM Is a *Rs.*2,000/Month Alternative

Pollity’s core intake channel—WhatsApp Business API—is accessible to any tech-savvy office manager via Interakt, Wati, or Zoko for *Rs.*1,500–3,000/month. A configured WhatsApp CRM with custom labels, auto-replies, and basic tagging replicates 40% of Jan-Sunwai’s functionality at one-tenth the price. This is the real competition at the councillor tier.

Recommendation

Restructure the competitive section to acknowledge these threats and explain specifically why Pollity wins despite them: CPGRAMS integration depth, multilingual NLP, governance-specific workflows, and aggregated data network effects. “No competitor exists” is not credible. “We win on these five dimensions” is.

Financial Projections: Disconnected from Operations

The Claim

By 2028, Pollity reaches 3,000 customers and \$1.1M ARR. By 2030, 25,000 customers and \$7.3M ARR.

The Problem

The projections are not connected to any hiring plan, sales motion, or operational model. Consider what 3,000 customers by end-2028 actually requires:

- Commercial launch assumed Q1–Q2 2027. That leaves roughly 18 months to sign 3,000 accounts.
- **Net new customer requirement: 167 per month, or 40 per week.**
- The Seed round (\$300–500K) allocates 30% to sales/marketing = \$90–150K.
- \$90K funds approximately 2 full-time sales hires in India for one year.
- Two salespeople closing 40 accounts per week is 20 accounts per person per week—physically impossible given the relationship-based, high-trust sales cycle the document itself describes.

Table 3: Operational Feasibility of Financial Projections

Year	New Customers	Required Closes	Weekly	Implied Sales Team
2027	500	10/wk		1–2 reps
2028	2,500	48/wk		8–10 reps
2029	5,000	96/wk		15–20 reps
2030	17,000	327/wk		50+ reps

The 2030 target requires a sales infrastructure that is never modelled or funded in any of the described rounds.

Recommendation

Rebuild projections from a bottom-up sales capacity model: how many salespeople, at what quota, in which geographies, funded by which round. Honest 2027 target: 150–200 customers, \$150–180K ARR. This is achievable and still impressive for a 12-month commercial operation.

Product Scope: Four Agents at Pre-Seed Is Scope Overreach

The Claim

Pollity delivers four intelligent platform agents (Jan-Sunwai, Vidhayak-Mitra, Vikas-Tracker, Nagrik-Setu) across six service areas with \$100K pre-seed capital.

The Problem

Each agent is a distinct, complex product:

Table 4: Engineering Complexity per Agent

Agent	Core Dependencies	Realistic Build Time
Jan-Sunwai	WhatsApp Business API, multi-lingual NLP, case management backend, CPGRAMS integration, rep dashboard	10–14 months (small team)
Vidhayak-Mitra	Legal database RAG, parliamentary proceedings (largely undigitized), policy brief generation in 22 languages	12–18 months
Vikas-Tracker	MPLADS portal integrations (different per state, mostly non-public APIs), finance ministry reporting	12–24 months (government API access alone takes 6–18 months)
Nagrik-Setu	Social media APIs (X/Twitter now paid, Meta restricted), multilingual content generation, multi-platform publishing	8–12 months

Building all four in parallel with a 3-person founding team and \$100K budget does not produce four working agents. It produces four broken prototypes.

Recommendation

MVP = Jan-Sunwai only. WhatsApp intake, Hindi/Marathi NLP, basic case management dashboard, no CPGRAMS integration in v1. Get 50 users using this one workflow well. The other three agents are roadmap items, not MVP scope. Investors fund focused bets—presenting four simultaneous products signals lack of prioritization.

CPGRAMS Integration: A Government Negotiation, Not a Technical Task

The Claim

CPGRAMS integration is listed as a core technical dependency and competitive moat, allocated from the \$55K product development budget.

The Problem

CPGRAMS is owned by DARPG (Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances), Ministry of Personnel. Integration requires:

1. A formal Memorandum of Understanding with DARPG
2. A security clearance and code audit by NIC
3. Recognition as a government-approved technology partner
4. Formal API access approval (CPGRAMS does not have a public API)

This process takes **12–36 months** minimum and requires political relationships at the ministry level that a pre-seed startup does not have. It cannot be purchased with product development budget.

Recommendation

Remove CPGRAMS from the MVP architecture entirely. Build Jan-Sunwai as a standalone grievance management system for the representative's own office. Position CPGRAMS integration as a Phase 2 feature unlocked after government partnerships are established. This is honest and buildable.

Bhashini: The Multilingual Claim Overstates Current Capability

The Claim

“Leveraging India’s Bhashini platform . . . Pollity can understand multilingual grievances and route them correctly without requiring citizens to select from 18,000+ subcategories.”

The Problem

- Bhashini’s ASR (automatic speech recognition) accuracy for informal spoken Hindi and Hinglish in noisy environments (village background noise, phone calls) is **60–75%** in real-world conditions—not the 90%+ required for reliable grievance classification.
- Bhashini has no production SLA. It is a government initiative with documented periodic outages. A production product cannot depend on infrastructure with no uptime guarantee.
- Grievance text from WhatsApp is informal, misspelled, code-switched, and emotionally complex. Fine-tuning a classification model on this data requires a labelled dataset of real grievances that **does not yet exist**.
- The auto-categorization claim (routing grievances across 18,000+ CPGRAMS subcategories without user input) is a state-of-the-art NLP research problem, not a product feature achievable with off-the-shelf Bhashini calls.

Recommendation

Reframe the multilingual claim: “Bhashini enables basic language detection and rough categorization; human review handles edge cases in v1.” Build a human-in-the-loop classification system for the MVP rather than claiming full automation. Accuracy improves with data collected during beta.

Political Neutrality: The Most Underrated Existential Risk

The Claim

Political neutrality breach is rated **Low probability / Critical impact**. Mitigation: “strict non-partisan policies; serve all parties equally; diverse customer base.”

The Problem

This is the most dangerous underestimation in the document.

- Pollity will hold constituency grievance patterns, voting demographic analytics, fund utilization data, and social media sentiment for representatives across all parties. This is among the most sensitive political data imaginable in Indian democratic context.
- A single incident—a data leak, a government data access order under the IT Act or the new DPDP Act, or a perception that data was shared across party lines—does not damage the product. It ends the company.
- The founding team has documented political affiliations: Piyush lists “Research Team Lead at Indian Nationalist Congress Party – SharadChandra Pawar” and Noorul lists “former I-PAC Media Analyst.” These are sales liabilities with BJP, AAP, and other non-INC/NCP representatives. A BJP MLA will not put their constituency data on a platform founded by an INC researcher and an I-PAC analyst.
- “Serve all parties equally” is a statement of intent. It is not a legal structure, a technical data isolation architecture, or a contractual protection.

Recommendation

This risk needs a three-part response: (1) **Legal:** Establish a data trust structure with independent governance; (2) **Technical:** Hard tenant isolation—no cross-account data access at the infrastructure level; (3) **Branding:** The founding team’s political backgrounds must be addressed proactively in sales conversations with non-INC representatives, not left as a liability to be discovered.

Team: The Core Capability Gap Is Not Acknowledged

The Claim

The team is presented as combining “deep government experience, political operations expertise, and data science capabilities.”

The Problem

This framing is accurate but incomplete. The founding team has strong domain knowledge and exceptional credentials. What it does not have—and the document does not acknowledge—is **a track record of shipping B2B SaaS products.**

- **Manav** built Elcare India, scaled to 15 employees. This is a service venture, not a SaaS product. The skills are different.
- **Piyush**’s background is quantitative research, econometrics, and financial data analysis—strong technical foundations, but no software product delivery experience in the resume.
- **Noorul**’s political operations background is invaluable for sales and partnerships. Zero relevance to product.

The “Key Hires Needed” section lists Head of Product, Head of Sales, and Senior Full-Stack Engineer. Listing these as needed hires signals that **the team cannot currently build or sell the product.** These are co-founder-level roles being treated as post-funding hires.

Recommendation

Either bring a technical co-founder with SaaS product delivery experience onto the team before the SNVC pitch, or reframe the narrative: “We are domain experts who have validated the problem and defined the solution. We are raising to hire the product and engineering talent to build it.” The second framing is honest and still fundable at pre-seed—but it must be said explicitly.

Pre-Seed Budget: \$100K Buys a Prototype, Not an MVP

The Claim

\$100K in pre-seed capital will produce a working MVP validated with 50 beta users, NPS > 40, and 5 documented case studies over 9–12 months.

The Problem

The honest output of \$100K with this team is: a functional WhatsApp grievance intake system with a basic web dashboard, tested with 10–15 beta users. That is still a meaningful MVP milestone—but the pre-seed success criteria as written (>50 users, NPS >40, 5 case studies) oversell what \$100K achieves.

Recommendation

Either raise the pre-seed ask to \$150–200K to match the milestones, or reduce the milestones to match the \$100K budget. Recommended revised milestones: functional Jan-Sunwai prototype, 15–20 active beta users, 3 documented case studies, NPS >30. These are achievable and still demonstrate product-market fit validation.

Table 5: Budget Reality Check

Category	Allocated	Realistic Need	Gap
Product Dev	\$55K	AWS Mumbai (\$1–2K/mo × 12) + WhatsApp Business API setup + backend contractor (min \$2,500/mo for 6 months) = \$42–54K infra/contractor alone, leaving \$1–13K for NLP pipeline, dashboard, mobile app	Tight to impossible
Beta Acquisition	\$20K	50 beta users in Delhi/Maharashtra requires 6–12 months of relationship outreach, 2–3 trips/month, user research sessions, onboarding support. \$20K = ~Rs.1.65L for 12 months of BD in two metros	Very tight
Operations & Legal	\$15K	Company incorporation + DPDP compliance assessment + ISO 27001 gap analysis = Rs.8–12L (\$10–14K) before any ongoing legal counsel	Barely adequate
Contingency	\$10K	10% on a complex regulated product in a new market is insufficient	Inadequate

Summary Scorecard

Table 6: Critical Assessment by Dimension

Dimension	Assessment	Rating
Problem identification	Real, documented, validated by CP-GRAMS data and fieldwork	Strong
Solution concept	Four-agent architecture logically maps to rep workflows	Strong
Market sizing (TAM)	Inflated 2–3× by freemium tier and illegal budget sources	Weak
Unit economics	Lifetime assumptions unsupported by electoral cycle data	Weak
Competitive analysis	I-PAC, NIC portals, and WhatsApp CRM alternatives omitted	Weak
Financial projections	Not connected to any operational or hiring model	Very Weak
Technical feasibility (MVP)	CPGRAMS and Bhashini risks unaddressed; scope too broad	Mixed
Team	Domain exceptional; SaaS delivery experience absent	Mixed
Political neutrality risk	Severity drastically underestimated; no structural mitigation	Weak
Pre-seed budget	\$100K buys prototype quality, not stated MVP milestones	Borderline

Overall Verdict

The core business thesis is **sound and worth building**. India’s 3.3 million elected representatives genuinely lack purpose-built governance tools. The founding team has the domain knowledge, political network, and UChicago credibility to launch this. The feasibility document, however, contains assumptions that will be exposed under investor scrutiny.

The three fixes that matter most before any investor conversation:

1. **Rebuild the financials** from a bottom-up sales capacity model. Remove the \$78.6M TAM headline. Lead with \$31M revised TAM and \$94–140K Year-1 SOM.
2. **Scope the MVP to Jan-Sunwai only**. No CPGRAMS. No four-agent architecture in v1. One agent, one workflow, 50 users, NPS >40.
3. **Address the political neutrality and team credibility gaps explicitly**. These

will be asked. Having the answers prepared demonstrates seriousness.